



THE PAN-AFRICAN PARLIAMENT OF THE AFRICAN UNION



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Letter from the Committee Director

Esteemed Members of Parliament,

Welcome to MUNI XXVIII! My name is Timothy Sakwa and it's my pleasure to serve as PAP Director this year. I'm a sophomore studying Political Science as well as Legal Studies. This will be my fourth year participating in Model UN and my second MUNI. I'm honored to have the opportunity to work with you all in creating a fun, informative MUN experience. I've always been particularly interested in regional organizations like the African Union because they offer a unique lens into how international cooperation works outside of the traditional United Nations system. Institutions such as the Pan-African Parliament demonstrate how states attempt to balance national sovereignty with regional coordination on issues like governance, security, and development, and I'm looking forward to seeing how delegates approach these questions throughout the weekend.

As a reminder, this committee will operate as a specialized General Assembly committee, meaning that while we will still follow many traditional Model UN procedures, the structure will differ slightly from a typical GA. Delegates will work toward drafting a Model Law while responding to developments throughout the weekend that may influence debate and negotiations.

When evaluating delegates, I tend to value strong collaboration, thoughtful debate, and creative yet realistic solutions.



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MUN is ultimately about working together to tackle complex global challenges, so delegates who are prepared, respectful, and willing to engage with others will find the most success in committee. I'm very excited to see the ideas, diplomacy, and creativity that each of you brings to the Pan-African Parliament. If you have any questions leading up to the conference, please feel free to reach out using the contact information below. I can't wait to see you all in action and if you need any assistance, feel free to email me using the address below!

Best,

Timothy Sakwa

Email: tsakwa2@illinois.edu



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Letter from the Committee Chair

Hello Affirmed MPs,

Welcome to MUNI XXVIII! My name is Joseph Reynold and I'm delighted to be the chair for PAP! I'm a Sophomore studying Economics and Political Science. This is my fourth year doing MUN and second year at MUNI. I'm excited to be a chair for this committee and to work with everyone to have a productive and entertaining experience. I'm interested in the Pan-African Parliament because of the important role that it plays in the continent. As it offers an opportunity for countries to collaborate and promote development for all members. I'm looking forward to seeing how everyone will engage with the issues present.

When I evaluate delegates, I watch for strong communication, challenging stances, and finding unique answers to solve problems. I personally believe that to thrive in MUN is to communicate original ideas to each other in order to find detailed, practical solutions. I'm looking forward to seeing everyone's innovative proposals and respectful diplomacy that each of you bring to the committee! Please feel free to reach out using my contact information below if anyone has any questions before the conference. Good luck to everyone and I'm very excited to see what everyone brings to MUNI XXVIII!

All the best,

Joseph Reynold

Email: jr70@illinois.edu



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List of Participating Countries

- Algeria
- Angola
- Botswana
- Cameroon
- Central African Republic
- Chad
- Congo
- Djibouti
- Democratic Republic of the Congo
- Egypt
- Eritrea
- Ethiopia
- Gabon
- Ghana
- Guinea
- Kenya
- Libya
- Madagascar
- Mali
- Mozambique
- Namibia
- Rwanda
- Senegal
- Somalia
- Sudan
- Tanzania
- Tunisia
- Uganda
- Zimbabwe



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Committee Logistics

This committee simulates the 2026 Session of the Pan-African Parliament (PAP), the advisory and consultative legislative body of the African Union. Unlike most General Assembly committees, the Pan-African Parliament does not pass binding international law. Instead, it drafts Model Laws: recommended legislative frameworks that African Union Member States may choose to adopt and adapt within their own national systems. These Model Laws are designed to promote harmonization and cooperation across the continent while still respecting national sovereignty and local needs. Delegates in this committee will represent Members of Parliament (MPs) from African Union Member States. At the start of the conference, MPs will debate both topic areas, after which the committee will vote to set the agenda and focus its work on one topic for the remainder of the conference. The final objective of the committee will be to draft and adopt a comprehensive Model Law addressing that selected topic.

Your goal in this committee will be to draft and adopt a comprehensive Model Law on the selected topic. MPs should focus on creating clear, realistic, and adaptable policy recommendations that could reasonably be implemented by AU Member States. Because this is a legislative simulation, your document should be structured clearly with articles or sections. The focus should be on:

- Establishing continent-wide standards or guiding principles
- Recommending institutional mechanisms
- Providing flexibility for national implementation

The final Model Law must receive a two-thirds majority of members present and voting to be adopted.

At designated points during the conference, selected MPs may receive confidential "Homeland Directives". These represent evolving instructions or political pressures from an MP's national government. As Model Laws are ultimately adopted and adapted by



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individual Member States, national interests remain highly relevant. MPs are expected to incorporate these directives into their negotiation strategy. Homeland Directives are confidential unless an MP chooses to share them. Not all MPs will receive directives at the same time.

Throughout the conference, the dais will periodically issue updates from a simulated continental news source. These bulletins may include political developments, economic shifts, security crises, or other events occurring within the African Union in 2026. MPs should respond to these developments through debate and adjustments to their draft Model Law. These updates are designed to reflect the dynamic environment in which continental policy is formulated.

This committee follows standard Model United Nations parliamentary procedure. MPs must raise their placards to be recognized for motions and points. The dais reserves the right to rule motions dilatory and to maintain order at all times. Professionalism and respect are expected throughout the weekend. While this committee includes dynamic elements, it remains a formal simulation of continental governance. Strong MPs will balance national interests with a willingness to build a broader consensus.



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Committee Background

The Pan-African Parliament (PAP) is one of the official organs of the African Union and was formally established in March 2004 under Article 17 of the AU's Constitutive Act. Its creation was first envisioned in the 1991 Treaty Establishing the African Economic Community, signed in Abuja, Nigeria, which called for stronger political and economic integration across the continent. The Protocol formally establishing the PAP has been ratified by the vast majority of African Union Member States. The Pan-African Parliament was created to provide a common platform for the peoples of Africa and their representatives to participate more directly in discussions about the continent's political, social, and economic challenges. While the African Union Assembly is composed of heads of state and government, the PAP serves as a parliamentary body, giving national legislators a voice at the continental level.

The Parliament consists of 275 members. Each African Union Member State sends five representatives from its national parliament, and at least one of those representatives must be a woman. These MPs are selected or elected by their national legislatures and are expected to reflect the political diversity of their home countries. The seat of the Pan-African Parliament is located in Midrand, South Africa. Currently, the PAP functions primarily as an advisory and consultative body rather than a fully empowered legislative institution. Its long-term goal, however, is to evolve into a parliament with full legislative authority whose members are directly elected by the citizens of African Union Member States.

Under its Protocol, the Pan-African Parliament has several important powers and responsibilities. It may examine and discuss matters affecting the African continent, either on its own initiative or at the request of other AU organs. The Parliament can make recommendations on issues such as human rights, democratic governance, rule of law, and good governance. It also reviews and discusses the budget of the African Union before it is approved and works toward the harmonization and coordination of laws among Member States.



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One of the most significant developments in the Parliament's work has been its role in drafting Model Laws. Model Laws are recommended legislative frameworks designed to help African Union Member States harmonize and modernize their domestic legal systems. While these laws are not binding, they serve as important tools for promoting continental standards in areas such as governance, public health, and institutional reform. Member States may adopt and adapt these Model Laws to fit their national contexts.



Topic #1: Promoting Democratic Stability and Security in Africa

Overview

—In the aftermath of decolonization and up until the present day, several regions across Africa have experienced cycles of political instability, contested elections, unconstitutional changes of government, and the expansion of non-state armed groups. These challenges have placed strain on national institutions and complicated efforts toward continental integration and long-term development. Just since 2020, multiple Member States, including but not limited to Mali, Burkina Faso, Guinea, and Niger have experienced military coups, prompting suspension from the African Union and renewed debate over how the AU should respond to unconstitutional changes of government. At the same time, extremist organizations such as Boko Haram in West Africa and al-Shabaab in East Africa continue to operate across borders, exploiting weak state capacity, local grievances, and porous frontiers. In the Sahel region in particular, insurgent violence has expanded despite both regional and international counterterrorism efforts.

The relationship between governance instability and insecurity is often cyclical. Disputed elections, corruption, and weakened democratic institutions can create political vacuums that armed groups exploit. Conversely, prolonged insecurity can justify emergency measures that limit civil liberties and strain democratic norms. The challenge facing the continent is therefore twofold: strengthening constitutional governance while improving coordinated responses to armed threats. The African Union has articulated guiding principles to address these concerns. The African Charter on Democracy, Elections and Governance (2007) commits Member States to constitutional rule, democratic participation, and the rejection of unconstitutional changes of government. Additionally, the AU's Peace and Security Architecture, including the Peace and Security Council, provides mechanisms for early warning, mediation, sanctions, and peace



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support operations. However, implementation has not always been consistent, and Member States often differ on how strongly the AU should intervene in domestic crises.

As the advisory and consultative parliamentary organ of the African Union, the Pan-African Parliament works to promote harmonization of legal standards and policy coordination. Though it does not pass binding laws, it can formulate Model Laws that recommend common frameworks for governance reform, security cooperation, and institutional resilience. Given the diversity of political systems across the continent: from consolidated democracies to transitional governments and military-led administrations, any proposed framework must carefully balance continental standards with national sovereignty. Under this topic, Members of Parliament must consider how to craft a Model Law that strengthens democratic stability while enhancing cooperation against non-state armed groups. The task will require addressing sensitive political questions, acknowledging regional differences, and proposing practical mechanisms that Member States would realistically consider adopting.

Past Continental Actions

— The African Union and its predecessor, the Organization of African Unity (OAU), have long grappled with the tension between sovereignty and intervention. While the OAU strongly emphasized non-interference, the AU adopted a more assertive doctrine of “non-indifference”, allowing collective response to grave circumstances such as war crimes, genocide, and unconstitutional seizures of power. In recent years, the AU has suspended Member States following coups, including Mali (2020, 2021), Guinea (2021), Burkina Faso (2022), and Niger (2023), signaling a formal rejection of unconstitutional transfers of power. However, debates have emerged over how quickly suspended states should be reinstated and what benchmarks should be required for a return to civilian rule.

On the security front, the AU has supported peace operations such as the African Union Mission in Somalia (AMISOM), aimed at countering al-Shabaab, and has coordinated with regional blocs to address insurgencies in the Sahel and Lake Chad Basin regions. The Multinational Joint Task Force (MNJTF), composed of several West



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and Central African states, was established to combat Boko Haram. These efforts demonstrate the importance of cross-border coordination, but despite these initiatives, non-state armed groups remain adaptive, and governance challenges persist. Not to mention that, in many cases, heavy reliance on military responses has not fully addressed underlying political or economic grievances.

The Pan-African Parliament, while not directly responsible for military or enforcement actions, has the authority to examine such issues, make recommendations, and propose harmonized legal frameworks. A new Model Law could clarify standards for democratic resilience, outline best practices for security coordination, and provide structured guidance to Member States navigating crises.



Questions a Model Law Should Answer

- What standards should define constitutional order and democratic stability within AU Member States?
- How should the African Union respond to unconstitutional changes of government while respecting national sovereignty?
- What legal frameworks can improve intelligence-sharing and cooperation against non-state armed groups operating across borders?
- How can Member States ensure that counterterrorism or counterinsurgency efforts do not undermine human rights or democratic institutions?
- What mechanisms can strengthen early warning systems and preventive diplomacy?
- How can the Pan-African Parliament recommend harmonized legal standards without imposing uniformity on different political systems?



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Topic #2: Infrastructure, Investment, and Development Financing

Overview

—Africa's economic integration and long-term development depend heavily on coordinated infrastructure across the continent. Transportation corridors, energy grids, digital networks, and trade facilitation systems are essential for connecting economies, enabling intra-African trade, and supporting sustainable growth. Yet, implementing continent-wide infrastructure projects is complex, requiring harmonized regulations, funding mechanisms, and governance standards that accommodate the political and economic diversity of the 55 African Union Member States, a challenge across such a large body.

Major initiatives such as the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), launched in 2021, have increased demand for cross-border infrastructure and streamlined trade routes. Similarly, the Program for Infrastructure Development in Africa (PIDA), endorsed by the African Union and the New Partnership for Africa's Development (NEPAD), aims to prioritize regional infrastructure projects, including transport corridors, energy networks, and ICT initiatives. Despite these efforts, funding gaps, coordination challenges, and governance disparities have slowed progress, and many projects remain incomplete or delayed.

Financing also remains a central challenge. While some infrastructure projects are supported by international investors or development banks, the AU encourages continental solutions to reduce dependency on external actors and to align projects with African priorities. At the same time, negotiations between Member States have often devolved into disagreements over priorities, as all governments must balance national interests with collective needs, ensuring that projects benefit multiple countries equitably and sustainably.

The Pan-African Parliament, while advisory, plays a crucial role in promoting harmonized policy frameworks and recommending legal standards for infrastructure



cooperation. Model Laws proposed by the PAP could provide guidelines on governance, transparency, financing, and regulatory harmonization, helping Member States coordinate effectively while respecting sovereignty and domestic priorities. MPs must weigh the trade-offs between efficiency, inclusivity, and equitable development when crafting proposals.

Past Continental Actions

— Over the past two decades, the African Union has spearheaded several initiatives to promote infrastructure integration. PIDA, adopted in 2012, established priority regional infrastructure projects for transport, energy, and ICT, seeking to link African economies while promoting sustainable development. PIDA also introduced a framework for coordinating Member States' policies and standards, though its success has been uneven due to funding limitations and differing national regulations. The AU has additionally facilitated or otherwise supported the creation of Regional Economic Communities (RECs), such as ECOWAS, SADC, and COMESA, which play a central role in implementing cross-border infrastructure projects. For instance, the North-South Corridor connects Southern African countries to major ports, facilitating trade while reducing transit costs and delays. Similarly, the Lagos-Abidjan Highway project aims to improve transport across West Africa but has faced challenges in harmonizing road standards and financing agreements.

Financial coordination has often involved partnerships with external actors, including the African Development Bank (AfDB), World Bank, and China's Belt and Road Initiative. While these partnerships have helped fill gaps, they have also raised concerns about debt sustainability, transparency, and alignment with continental priorities. The AU has encouraged stronger continental mechanisms to govern financing and procurement, highlighting the need for Model Laws that set common standards and guidelines.



Questions a Model Law Should Answer

- What legal and regulatory frameworks should guide continental infrastructure projects to ensure harmonization across Member States?
- How can financing mechanisms be structured to reduce dependence on external actors while ensuring sustainability and equitable distribution?
- What transparency and anti-corruption safeguards should be included in infrastructure governance?
- How can regional economic communities coordinate effectively while respecting national priorities?
- What standards should ensure that large-scale projects benefit multiple countries fairly and contribute to long-term development?
- How can the Pan-African Parliament recommend policies that balance efficiency, equity, and national sovereignty?



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Topic #2:

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